Question ID db422e7f

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Algebra	Linear equations in two variables	

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Line p is defined by $4y + 8x = 6$. Line r is perpendicular to line p in the *xy*-plane. What is the slope of line r?

ID: db422e7f Answer

Correct Answer:
.5, 1/2

Rationale

The correct answer is $\frac{1}{2}$. For an equation in slope-intercept form $y = mx + b$, m represents the slope of the line in the *xy*-plane defined by this equation. It's given that line p is defined by $4y + 8x = 6$. Subtracting $8x$ from both sides of this equation yields $4y = -8x + 6$. Dividing both sides of this equation by 4 yields $y = -\frac{8}{4}x + \frac{6}{4}$, or $y = -2x + \frac{3}{2}$. Thus, the slope of line p is -2. If line r is perpendicular to line p, then the slope of line r is the negative reciprocal of the slope of line p. The negative reciprocal of -2 is $-\frac{1}{(-2)} = \frac{1}{2}$. Note that 1/2 and .5 are examples of ways to enter a correct answer.

Question Difficulty:
Hard